SwimSignal

River · River Thames

River Thames, Port Meadow, Oxford

Moderate risk

Sewage spills tomorrow

High risk on Saturday

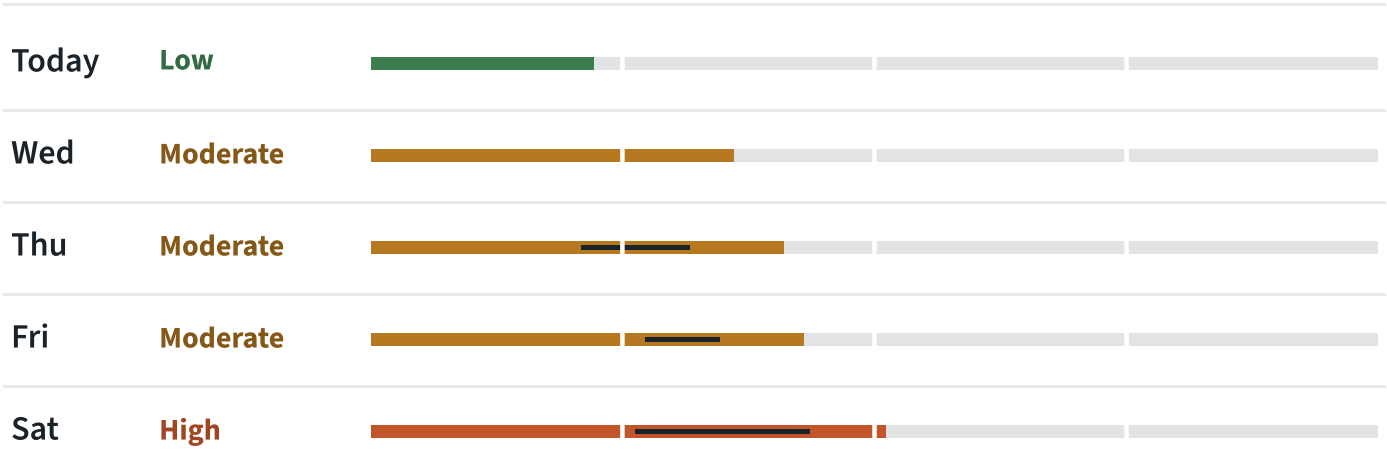
Take more care: young children, older people and anyone with a weakened immune system may want a lower day or spot.

This forecast counts sewage from the monitored storm overflows upstream, and the rain that makes them spill. It does not count treated sewage from sewage works, runoff from farmland and roads, wildlife or other bathers.

Issued Tue 06:39, 1 h 51 min ago

Pollution risk, next five days

About 9 of the 29 overflows upstream are expected to spill today, about 16 on Friday.



A forecast, not a water test: check the signs at the water before you swim. This is not a designated bathing water, so the Environment Agency does not test it for bathing.

Lower risk nearby

Pangbourne Meadow, River Thames

Low risk now · Moderate risk on Thursday

22 miles away · River · bathing water

River Thames, Henley-on-Thames

Low risk now · Moderate risk on Thursday

23 miles away · River

Lower now, and no higher on any of the five days. A lower forecast level, not clean water: check the signs there too.

Know this spot?

Add a practical guide

Where you parked, the way down, where you got in and out. Photos are welcome.

Sewage spills

13 of 100

Low risk

Tomorrow's sewage spill risk raises the level to moderate risk.

About 9 of the 29 overflows upstream are expected to spill today.

The sewage spill risk, a 0–100 score for sewage from upstream reaching the spot, after travel time, die-off and dilution. A score, not a probability. Low under 15, moderate 15 to 40, high 40 to 70, very high 70 or more. What this counts

Right now

0 discharging

None stopped lately: a spill counts until 48 h after its water has passed here. 28 of 29 report live; the one that does not could be spilling unseen.

E. coli estimate

57%

Untested in October

Chance a water sample would show E. coli over 900 per 100 ml today; 68% tomorrow. The level above counts sewage spills. This estimate counts E. coli from any source, but it is tested only for May to September, so it is not part of the level now. It has not yet shown skill on live samples: on the 39 Environment Agency samples since the forecast began, it did no better than chance at picking out the ones over 900.

The minimum bathing-water standard lets about one sample in ten be over 900. On the 39 live samples so far, its AUC is 0.51: 0.5 is chance, 1 is perfect. What this counts

River level

0.71 m

Usual level

0.50 1.30 m

Not part of the pollution level. Gauge at Farmoor on the River Thames, 5.4 km away, Tue 06:15.

A high river runs faster and colder, and after rain it can rise quickly. The Environment Agency's page for this gauge has the last five days.

Rain here

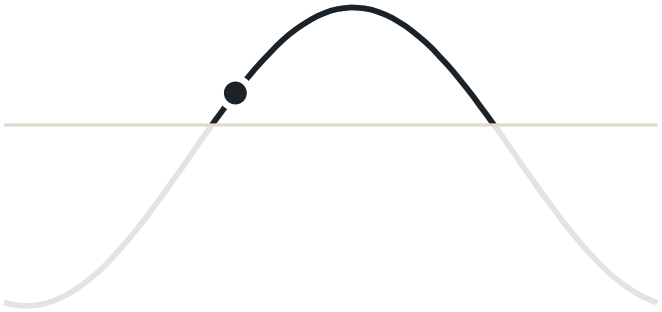
19 mm



In the 48 h to midday today. The most ahead: 32 mm in the 48 h to midday Saturday.

Weather

12° C high



Sunrise 07:38, sunset 18:00.

Weather data by Open-Meteo.com

What the level rests on

Overflows upstream **1 h 51 min ago**

0 discharging. 28 of 29 report live. Not reporting: 1 offline.

The water companies' live feeds.

Rain here **1 h 51 min ago**

19 mm of rain in the 48 h to midday today. The most ahead is 32 mm in the 48 h to midday Saturday.

Open-Meteo.com's forecast.

No lab samples, algae checks or rating here.

How the forecast has done here

Since 29 Sept the forecast has been checked at 28 of the 29 overflows upstream: 521 overflow-days, none with a spill.

With no spills, there is nothing yet to judge its warnings by. It gave 7 false alarms: forecasts at the High risk line on days with no spill.

Every overflow's scores, on the Accuracy page

An overflow-day is one overflow on one day. Each spill counts once for every forecast made for it, from four days ahead to that morning, as on the Accuracy page. A warning is a spill chance of 40% or more at the overflow: where a spot right beside it reads High risk. A share is given from 10 spill days. Each overflow counts the same, however much of a spill would reach here. An overflow with no live feed, or with no day that passed the scoring rules, cannot be scored.

Overflows that matter most

- **Standlake sewage works overflow**
  Standlake STW · Thames Water · not discharging · last ended 19 Mar · 20.5 km upstream, about 29 h away
  16% reach
  spill 61% today

- **Cassington sewage works overflow**
  Cassington STW · Thames Water · not discharging · last ended 2 Oct 2024 · 4.7 km upstream, about 7 h away
  81% reach
  spill 9% today

- **Combe sewage works overflow**
  Combe STW · Thames Water · not discharging · last ended 29 Aug · 19.8 km upstream, about 27 h away
  17% reach
  spill 35% today

Overflow history, 2021 to 2025

The 10 of the 29 overflows upstream that matter most this week, most first: one matters more the more of a spill would reach here, the likelier it is to spill this week, and if it is discharging now. Each with its live status and today's modelled chance of a spill. Reach: the share of a spill's bacteria the model expects to arrive here, after die-off over the travel time and dilution by the size of the river network upstream. An estimate, not a measured chance.

Day-by-day numbers

Day	Sewage spill risk	Risk	E. coli estimate	Rain 48 h
Today	13	Low	57%†	19 mm
Tomorrow	26	Moderate	68%†	19 mm
Thu 22 Oct	31	Moderate	64%†	12 mm
Fri 23 Oct	33	Moderate	72%†	27 mm
Sat 24 Oct	41	High	77%†	32 mm

†Outside May to September, when the Environment Agency takes no samples: untested. What this means It has not yet shown skill on live samples: on the 39 Environment Agency samples since the forecast began, it did no better than chance at picking out the ones over 900.

Sewage spill risk: a 0–100 score for sewage from upstream reaching the spot, from Open-Meteo rainfall through a spill model trained on 743,735 United Utilities discharge events (2023–25) and verified on a held-out

year, then travel time, die-off and dilution. Not a probability. **E. coli estimate**: the estimated chance that a midday sample would show over 900 E. coli per 100 ml, from rain at the spot in the 48 h to midday, the sewage spill risk, and season. Daily resolution. What the levels mean · How accurate is it?

Technical details

River speed	0.2 m/s
Lake crossing speed	0.05 m/s
Bacteria die-off	90% in 72 h (T90)
Searched upstream	60 km
Counts as a recent spill	until 48 h after its water has passed
Spill model	United Utilities 2023-2025 (refit on all years; verified on 2025 before refit)
Lead-time calibration	on
E. coli model	E. coli > 900 cfu/100 ml, fitted on 1,502 samples
Version	`spill=808da63d;cal=9b3cc24c;ecoli=e601ea37;code=0.1.0+57417e1;rain=open-meteo-forecast`

Data: storm overflow status from Anglian, Northumbrian, Severn Trent, South West, Southern, Thames, United Utilities, Wessex and Yorkshire Water via the National Storm Overflow Hub (CC BY 4.0; combined and modelled by SwimSignal) · Environment Agency data © Environment Agency copyright and/or database right (OGL v3.0); river levels: this uses Environment Agency flood and river level data from the real-time data API (Beta) · Contains OS data © Crown copyright and database right 2026 · Weather data by Open-Meteo.com (CC BY 4.0), from Met Office forecasts © Crown copyright (CC BY-SA 4.0) · Map © OpenStreetMap contributors. None of these bodies endorses SwimSignal. All credits and licences.